What our people are telling us

What employees value, what they want fixed first, and how we can start in 90 days.

327 people · 30 questions · 1,892 written comments

30 OCTOBER 2026 / TISS

Source: Your Voice survey (responses to 21 October); analysis 30 October 2026.

Three things to remember

If you remember nothing else from today, remember these.

1 **People are proud of Safewater Lines.**

92% are proud to work here. 91% say their team helps each other.

2 **They want people decisions to be fair and clear.**

Promotions, rewards and recognition get the lowest scores of all 30 questions.

3 **They want leaders to listen, and then act.**

It was the No. 1 thing people asked HR to do better.

> **Our plan: one 90-day pilot with three parts, starting in Customer Service.**

Source: item_evidence_profile.csv; hr_priority_counts.csv; priority_triangulation.csv.

Who took part

Answers came from across India and abroad, in five languages.

327
people answered

5
languages

23
locations

1,892
written comments

BIGGEST GROUPS

Mumbai 40% of answers · Less than 3 years' service 38% · Men 79%, women 20%

We were not given the total headcount, so we cannot say what share of employees took part.

Source: survey_clean.csv; workbook language sheets.

How to read the numbers

Every question had the same five answers.

1	2	3	4	5
Almost never	Rarely	Sometimes	Usually	Almost always
			= positive	

“80% positive” means 8 in 10 people answered Usually or Almost always.

“Sometimes” is the middle answer. We do not count it as positive.

Source: Survey answer scale; favourable = 4–5.

The good news: people are proud and they help each other

Share of people answering Usually or Almost always.



These are the strengths to protect while we fix the gaps.

Source: item_evidence_profile.csv (PRI2, PRI1, CAM1, CAM3).

One warning: answers with a name look more positive

The survey asked for an optional name. Most people gave it.

PLAN TO STAY FOR THE NEXT 3–5 YEARS

92%

People who gave their name (227)

78%

People who stayed anonymous (100)

69% of people typed their name on the survey.

Anonymous people were less positive on every key question.

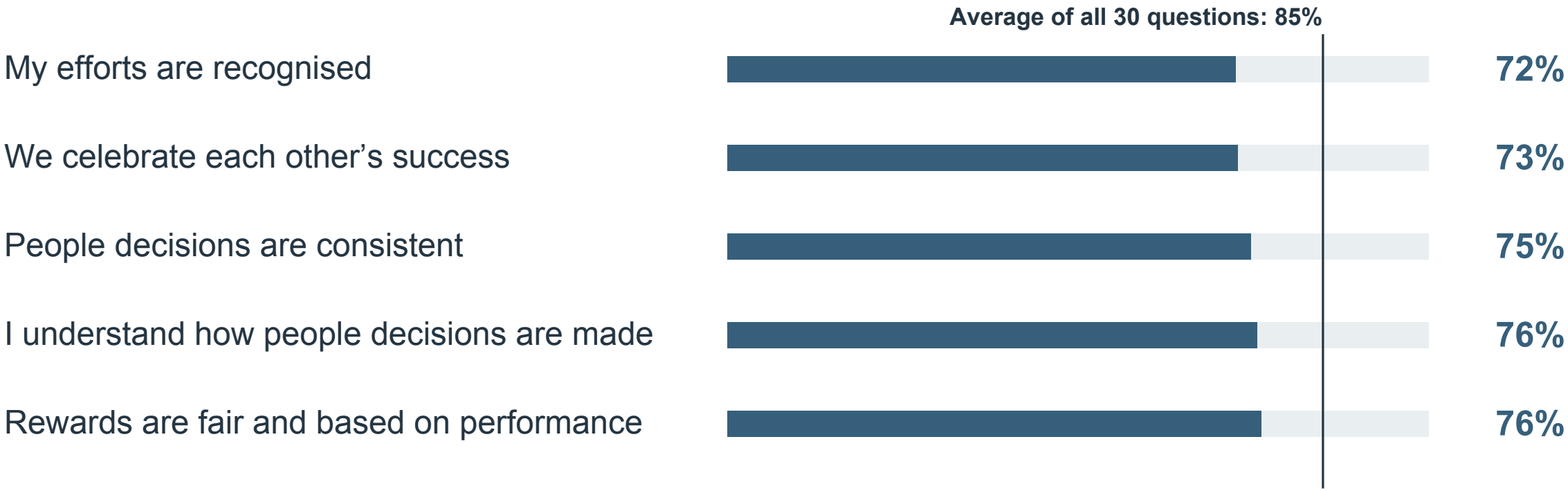
So the true picture is probably a little less rosy.

> **Simple fix: don’t ask for names in the next survey.**

Source: named_vs_anonymous.csv; notebook Step 7.4.

Where it hurts: the five lowest scores

Share of people answering Usually or Almost always. All five are about fairness and recognition.



All five lowest scores are about how people decisions are made, explained and recognised.

Source: item_evidence_profile.csv (RES4, CAM5, FAI3, FAI5, FAI1).

How we decided what to fix first

We listened in four different ways. A real priority should show up in all of them.

1

Low score

Which questions get the lowest scores?

2

Linked to staying

Which questions move together with wanting to stay and recommend?

3

HR wish list

What one thing did people ask HR to do better?

4

In their own words

What did people raise when asked for “one change”?

> **A real priority should pass all four. We set the pass marks before looking at the results.**

Source: Notebook Step 7.3; pass marks fixed before reading the result.

Two themes pass all four tests

Filled circle = strong; light = medium; empty = weak; dash = not asked.

THEME	LOW SCORE	LINKED TO STAY	HR WISH LIST	OWN WORDS	OUR DECISION
Fair decisions & career growth	●	●	●	●	**Priority 1**
Leaders listen and act	●	●	●	●	**Priority 2**
Recognition	●	○	◔	●	**Part of Priority 1**
Teamwork across teams	◔	●	—	○	**Targeted fix**
Pay, benefits & facilities	—	—	●	◔	**Yearly review**

Only the first two themes are strong on all four tests.

Source: priority_triangulation.csv; notebook Step 7.3.

Priority 1: fair decisions that people understand

Promotions, pay rises, rewards and recognition.

75% say people decisions are made consistently, one of the lowest scores

No. 1 Of the areas leaders can change, fairness is most linked to wanting to stay

51 people said HR’s main job should be helping careers grow

> “Inconsistent performance evaluations and opaque promotion criteria.”

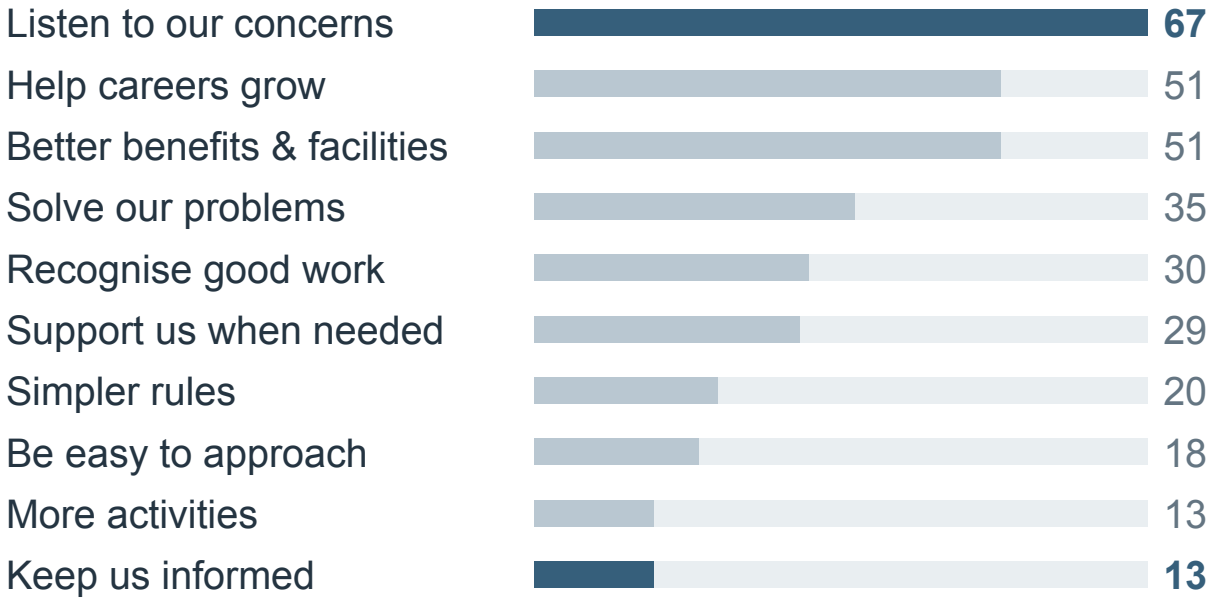
An employee, answering the fairness question

In practice: clear rules for promotion, pay and rewards, and a reason for every decision.

Source: item_evidence_profile.csv; driver_model_summary.csv; hr_priority_counts.csv; quote verbatim, de-identified.

Priority 2: leaders who listen, and then act

"If HR could do one thing better…": everyone picked one answer.



80%

say leaders act on feedback today

> "Employees' problems and suggestions should be heard and appropriate action taken promptly."

> **In practice: every concern gets an owner, a date and an answer.**

Source: hr_priority_counts.csv; item_evidence_profile.csv (CRE5); quote verbatim, de-identified.

Where to start: Customer Service

% positive by group. Darker = lower. Groups with at least 10 people.

	FAIR DECISIONS	LEADERS ACT	RECOGNITION	PLAN TO STAY
Everyone (327)	75%	80%	72%	87%
Customer Service (51)	**64%**	**69%**	**57%**	**76%**
Sales (54)	75%	74%	72%	87%
Documentation (59)	77%	85%	81%	92%
Finance & Accounts (38)	85%	82%	84%	92%
Operations (36)	88%	89%	86%	92%
3–5 years' service (53)	68%	75%	66%	79%

Women answer less positively than men on fair decisions and recognition (9–13 points lower).

Source: group_hotspots.csv; notebook Step 7.5.

A smaller fix: handovers between teams

People help their own team. Work between teams is harder.

My own team helps each other



91%

Teams across the company work well together



82%

45

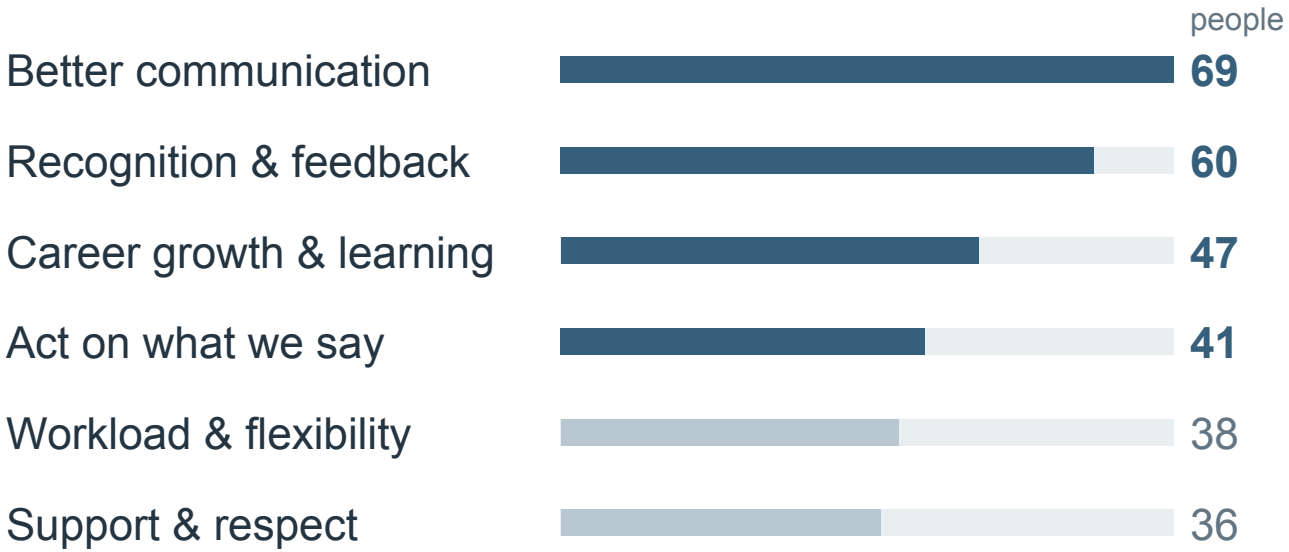
people rate their own team well but work with other teams poorly

> **The fix: one Customer Service handover. Who sends what, who receives it, who covers.**

Source: cross_team_paired_detail.csv; item_evidence_profile.csv (CAM1, CAM2).

What else people told us

“If you could make one change…”: the question that did not suggest any topic.



ALSO HEARD

Pay, benefits & facilities

51 people picked this as HR’s main job.

Send it to the yearly pay and facilities review, and tell people that is where it went.

A 90-day pilot cannot fix pay. Being open about where it goes still builds trust.

Source: one_change_topics.csv; hr_priority_counts.csv.

Our plan: one 90-day pilot, three parts

Starting in Customer Service. Using the tools and processes we already have.

1 / Fair decisions

OWNER

HR head

- Publish clear rules for promotion, pay and rewards.
- Give a reason for every decision.
- Managers recognise each person monthly.

2 / Listen and act

OWNER

Leadership sponsor + HR

- Log every concern with an owner and a date.
- Monthly “you said, we did” update.
- Listening sessions, Customer Service first.

3 / Handovers

OWNER

Operations head

- Map one Customer Service handover.
- Agree who sends, receives and covers.
- Flag anything overdue.

No new system is needed. Owners are our proposal and need leadership approval.

Source: implementation_roadmap_0_90_days.csv (revised IDs P1, P2, T); proposed owners, not approved commitments.

90 days, step by step

Day 0 is the day leadership approves the pilot.

DAYS 0–14

Get ready

Pick pilot teams. Check today’s rules. Short anonymous survey.

DAYS 15–30

Set up

Publish rules. Name owners. Open the concern log.

DAYS 31–60

Run it

Monthly recognition and updates. Weekly problem review.

DAYS 61–90

Decide

Repeat the short survey. Grow it, change it or stop it.

At each step, leadership decides whether to continue.

Source: roadmap_decision_gates.csv (adapted).

How we will know it worked

Check that we did the work, and that employees noticed.

PART	WE CHECK THAT…	EMPLOYEES SHOULD SAY… (TODAY → GOAL)
Fair decisions	Rules are published for every pilot role, with a reason for each decision.	“Decisions are consistent”: 75% → about 80%
Listen and act	Every concern is answered within 2 working days and has an owner.	“Leaders act on feedback”: 80% → about 85%
Handovers	At least 95% of handovers are complete by Day 60.	“Teams work well together”: 82% → higher
Protect strengths	No extra paperwork beyond the agreed logs.	Pride 92% and own-team help 91% do not drop

Measured with a short anonymous survey. Goals are suggestions to confirm in the first 14 days.

Source: roadmap_kpi_dictionary.csv; item_evidence_profile.csv. Targets are suggestions to confirm in the first 14 days.

What we ask you to decide today

Three decisions to get started.

01

Approve one 90-day pilot

Fair decisions, listen and act, and one handover, starting in Customer Service.

02

Name the owners

HR head, a leadership sponsor and the Operations head, with one review a month.

03

Run the next survey without names

A short anonymous survey now, and again at Day 90.

Source: implementation_roadmap_0_90_days.csv; roadmap_decision_gates.csv.

Thank you. Questions?

Before questions, three honest limits.

WHAT WE CAN AND CANNOT SAY

- The links we show are not proof of cause and effect.
- We do not know the total headcount, so we cannot give a response rate.
- Comments were read with AI help and checked once, not by an independent team.

> **Happy to take questions. We can show any result by department or tenure.**

Source: Safewater_Lines_Full_Reference.pdf; dashboard/dist/index.html.